

Yannan Li

Behavioural Neuroscience · Mouse Models

Experimental Neuroscience & Data Analysis

University College London, London, United Kingdom

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RESEARCH PROFILE

UCL Biomedical Sciences undergraduate with hands-on experience in mouse husbandry, behavioural paradigms and systematic data recording, complemented by tissue processing, PCR/qPCR, Western blotting, immunofluorescence and c-Fos staining. Seeking to support experimental neuroscience through rigorous animal work, accurate record-keeping and experimental troubleshooting.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Prof. Tianmei Si, Psychopharmacology Laboratory, Peking University Sixth Hospital

Beijing, China

Research Intern

Jul 2024 – Oct 2024

- Designed behavioural paradigms and conducted experiments in DAT-Cre transgenic mice, including conditioned reflex and early-life stress models, Morris water maze (MWM), sucrose preference test (SPT), open field (OFT) and tail suspension tests (TST).
- Handled and monitored over 100 mice, including ear-punch identification, routine husbandry, feeding, daily health monitoring and systematic behavioural data recording.
- Assisted with perfusion, blood collection, brain collection and sectioning for a study cohort of over 400 mice.
- Performed PCR-based genotyping and qPCR, Western blotting, immunofluorescence and c-Fos immunostaining to relate behavioural phenotypes to molecular readouts; maintained records, troubleshoot procedures and assisted with manuscript preparation.

Prof. Jiandong Jiang, Virus Pharmacology Laboratory, Institute of Biotechnology, Chinese Academy of Medical Sciences & Peking Union Medical College

Beijing, China

Research Intern

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

- Performed cell-based antiviral drug screening using HSV-1 and Coxsackievirus B3 infection models.
- Conducted mammalian cell culture, cytotoxicity assays, cytopathic effect (CPE) assessment, IC₅₀ determination, PCR-based viral detection and Western blotting.
- Integrated cell viability, viral replication and protein expression data; assisted with experimental planning, data interpretation and presentation of findings.

Prof. Alasdair Gibb, University College London

London, United Kingdom

Research Project in Neuroparmacology

Sep 2023 – Jun 2025

- Conducted a systematic review on the role of calcium channel blockers in Parkinson's disease.
- Conducted a meta-analysis of clinical evidence, including study selection, data extraction, statistical interpretation and evidence synthesis.

Dr. Dean Willis, University College London

London, United Kingdom

Research Project in Cancer Mechanobiology and Immunotherapy

Sep 2022 – Jun 2023

- Reviewed mechanosensitive Piezo channels in cancer progression and therapy, synthesising evidence on mechanotransduction, tumour biology, immune responses and therapeutic sensitivity.

Prof. Xia Zhao, Marine Glycol-Engineered Drugs Lab, Ocean University of China

Qingdao, China

Research Intern

Aug 2022

- Extracted, isolated and characterised marine-derived polysaccharides using HPLC, GC-MS and NMR.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Animal Behaviour	Mouse husbandry, DAT-Cre models, behavioural paradigm design, observation and data recording
Behavioural Tests	MWM, SPT, OFT and TST, early-life stress models and conditioned reflex paradigms
Animal Procedures	Ear-punch identification, perfusion assistance, blood collection, brain collection and sectioning
Wet Lab	Cell culture, PCR/qPCR, Western blotting, CPE assessment, drug screening, c-Fos and immunofluorescence staining
Data Analysis	Behavioural data recording and organisation; statistical analysis using Excel and Python
Research Practice	Literature review, record-keeping, SOP adherence, troubleshooting, scientific writing and presentations
Languages	Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent), Japanese (Conversational), French (Conversational)

EDUCATION

University College London (UCL)

London, United Kingdom

BSc Biomedical Sciences

Expected Graduation: 2026

- Specialisation:** Drug Mechanisms, with emphasis on Pharmacology and Neurosciences.
- Predicted classification:** Upper Second-Class Honours (2:1).

Pennon Education

China

A-Levels: Biology, Chemistry, Mathematics, Further Mathematics

2019 – 2021

- Grades:** Biology (A), Chemistry (A), Mathematics (A), Further Mathematics (A).

LEADERSHIP & ACADEMIC SERVICE

Biomedical Sciences, University College London

London, United Kingdom

Transition Mentor

Sep 2022 – Dec 2022

- Supported first-year Biomedical Sciences students with their transition to university, study planning and academic adjustment.

Academic Seminars and Workshops, Micro Distance Youth Forum

Co-organiser

Aug 2023

- Assisted in organising academic seminars and workshops, including speaker coordination and event preparation.